

Photograph by Isamu Sawa

Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

Signet 01 is a silver signet ring. The square spiral cut into its face makes the entire object resonate as a finely tuned antenna. Touched to a phone, the ring seals a written message with a mark that anyone can verify and no one can forge.

How it works

1 **Write.** Open the Signet app on your iPhone and write the words you want to stand behind.

2 **Touch.** Hold the ring to your phone. The phone powers the chip, and the ring signs.

3 **Share.** The words are sealed as a permanent public record, with a link you can send to anyone.

The seal

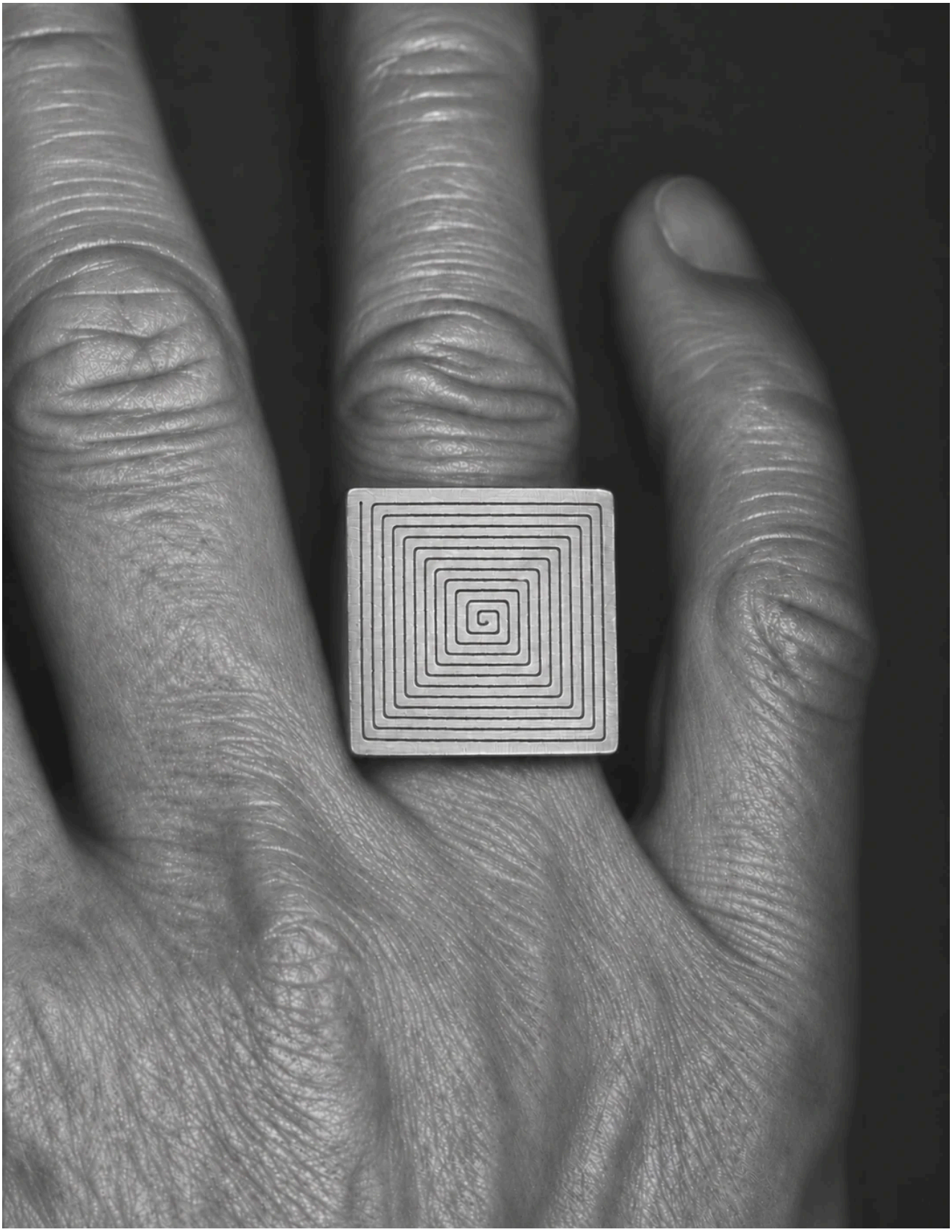
Every seal has its own page. It shows the words, the number of the ring and the date, and confirms that the ring signed them. It opens in any browser. The reader needs no app and no account.

A seal proves that this ring signed these exact words, and when. If one character changes, the seal no longer matches. The key that signs is made inside the ring and never leaves it.

The object

Cast in 925 sterling silver and finished by hand. The twelve-turn square spiral is the only break in the silver. The chip sits beneath it, behind a laser-welded closure. There is no battery. The phone powers the ring each time it signs.

The silver is made to be inherited. If required, the studio can renew the electronics and refinish the silver.



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The project
2022 to 2026

I began this work in early 2022 with a question: how could a physical object take part in the digital world?

At the time, the connection between a physical object and its digital identity was usually an NFC tag added afterwards, perhaps to the back of a painting. It gave the object a digital identifier, but had little to do with its form or meaning. I wanted the technology to belong to the object itself.

So I made the antenna the form. A series of sculptural studies followed, each pushing the antenna further from anything an engineer would normally draw. The spiral was inescapable. An antenna has to coil, and wound square to fill the face of a ring it becomes a single line that travels to a centre with no branch and no dead end. That is the unicursal path of the labyrinth, struck on the coins of Knossos and set into the floor of Chartres, and it has long stood for focus and reflection. The physics had led me to one of the oldest marks we have.

The project changed when I replaced the standard NFC chip with a secure element. The tag became a key. A secure element makes and holds a private key, so the object can do something that anyone can check.

The signet gave that key a purpose. For five thousand years, a signet pressed into clay or warm wax let a person put their mark on their own words. Augustus sealed his letters with a sphinx, and later with his own portrait. For five centuries, a pope's ring was broken at his death so that nothing more could be sealed in his name. A seal was how the world knew who was speaking.

In recent centuries the signet was reduced to an ornament. Now that any text can be written in a person's name, its mark is needed again. An old object has its work back. Behind every seal there is a physical gesture.

The return of the seal, the resonance of the antenna and the path of the labyrinth are what made this project irresistible: form, function and meaning in one object.

Signet 01 is the first complete expression of the idea: a silver ring, a key that never leaves it, and a deliberate touch of the hand. It is the work I am proudest of.



Jim Hannon-Tan
Adelaide, 2026

The designer

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer based in Adelaide. He developed his practice over fifteen years in Milan, London and Amsterdam, in the studios of Tom Dixon and Marcel Wanders, on work for Baccarat, Christofle, Flos and Louis Vuitton, before setting up his own studio in Australia.

His own work spans consumer products, medical devices and advanced manufacturing, for Alessi, Alimetry and Schneider Electric. It has been shown at the Triennale di Milano and the Tokyo National Museum.

He conceived Signet 01 and has directed every part of it: the form, the antenna, the electronics, the casting and the record.

Signet 01 follows Near Field Circuit (2025), ten brass NFC objects, each with its own digital record on LUKSO. All ten are held by collectors.

Made with

Prototype machining	Australian National Fabrication Facility
Casting	Morris & Watson
Bench work	Shannon Cornish
Mechanical engineering	Varghese Liju
Electronic engineering	Aaron Mohtar
RF and antenna	Dr Shengjian Chen, Flinders University
Ledger and application	Aureliano Alarcón Smith
Photography	Isamu Sawa

Founding Edition

Edition	Ten numbered rings, and two artist's proofs
Material	925 sterling silver, hallmarked
Price	US$10,000
Delivered with	The Signet app for iPhone
Delivery	From the first quarter of 2027

Specification

Reference	S01.AG
Antenna	12-turn square spiral, 13.56 MHz (NFC)
Chip	Arx HaLo secure element, passive, no battery
Key	Made on the chip. It cannot be exported
Record	Seals are recorded on LUKSO, a public ledger

With thanks

Fabian Vogelsteller	Co-founder of LUKSO
Cameron Robertson	Founder of Arx Research
Richard McMahon	R. McMahon Watchmakers
New Venture Institute	Tonsley

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Enquiries

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